UX Case Study: Zomato

CodeAlpha Internship — Month 1 · Task 3 (UI/UX Design) · Prepared by: Intern

1. Introduction

Zomato is a leading food-delivery and restaurant-discovery platform. This case study analyzes its user journey, highlights strengths and weaknesses, and proposes three evidence-based improvements with mockups.

2. User Journey Analysis

1. **Discovery:** User opens app → sees banners, collections, search bar.
2. **Search & Filter:** Types restaurant/dish → applies cuisine/price/rating filters.
3. **Selection:** Views restaurant page → menu, ratings, reviews, photos.
4. **Cart:** Adds items → customizes (size, toppings) → reviews cart.
5. **Checkout:** Selects address → payment → applies coupon → places order.
6. **Tracking:** Live order tracking → delivery → rating/review.

3. Strengths

Fast search & rich filters: Quick restaurant/dish search with cuisine, price, rating filters.

Live order tracking: Real-time map tracking builds trust and reduces anxiety.

Multiple payment options: Cards, UPI, wallets, COD — broad accessibility.

Reviews & photos: User-generated content aids decision-making.

Personalized collections: "Best of" lists surface relevant choices.

4. Weaknesses

Cluttered home screen: Too many banners, collections and pop-ups overwhelm first-time users.

Aggressive upselling: Pop-ups for Zomato Gold/Pro interrupt the ordering flow.

- **Inconsistent filters:** Filter placement differs between search and restaurant pages.
- **Checkout friction:** Address selection and coupon application require multiple taps.
- **Accessibility gaps:** Low contrast on some labels; small tap targets on chips.
- **Dark patterns:** Pre-selected "donate a meal" and auto-applied tips.

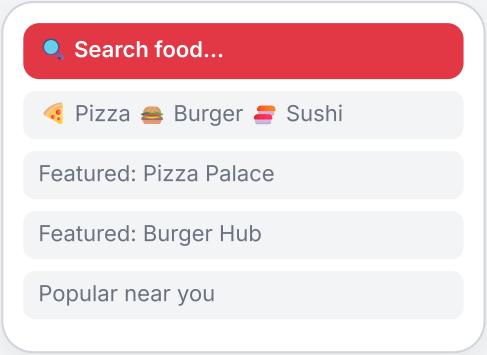
5. Proposed Improvements

Improvement 1 — Simplified Home & Smart Search

Discovery Reduce cognitive load by decluttering the home screen and making search the primary action.

- Single prominent search bar at top; categories as horizontal scrollable chips below.
- Limit to 3 featured collections; move rest to "Explore" tab.
- Remove auto pop-ups; show offers as dismissible inline cards.

Sketch: Simplified Home

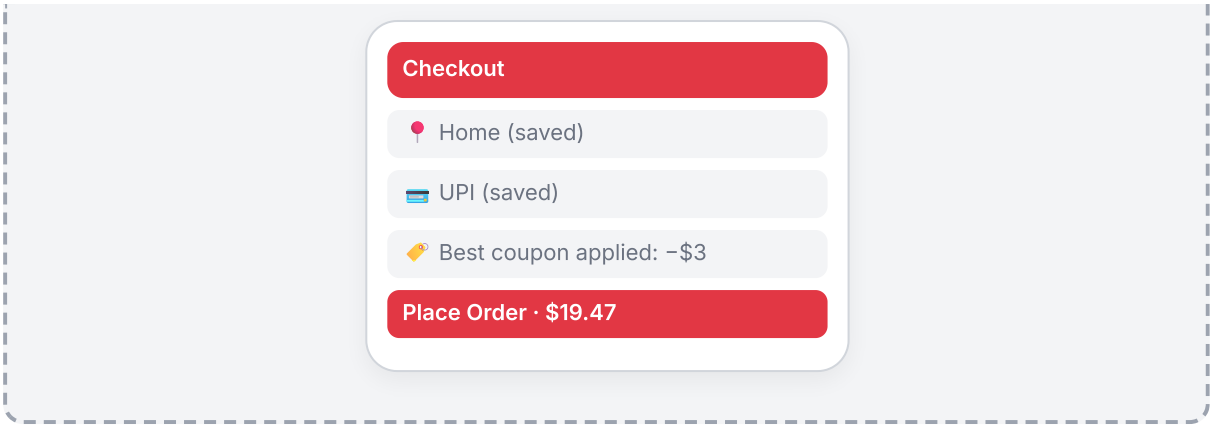


Improvement 2 — Streamlined Checkout

Conversion Cut checkout steps from 5 taps to 2 by remembering preferences.

- Auto-select last-used address and payment method.
- One-tap coupon application with best-offer auto-suggest.
- Remove pre-selected donations/tips; make them opt-in with clear labels.

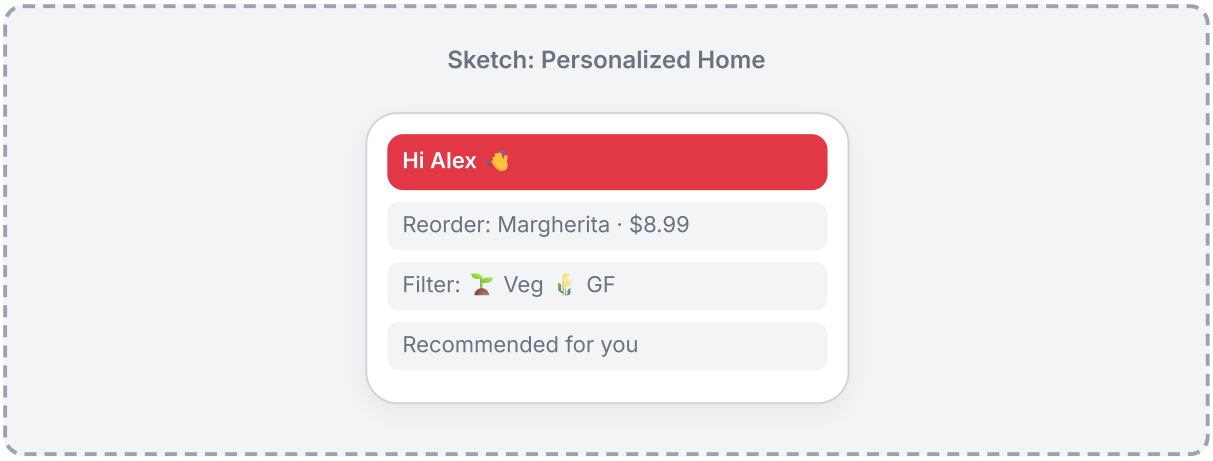
Sketch: One-screen Checkout



Improvement 3 — Personalized & Inclusive Discovery

Engagement Help users find food that fits their needs and diet.

- Dietary filters (veg/vegan/gluten-free) persisted across sessions.
- "Reorder" shortcut on home for last 3 orders.
- Improved contrast and larger tap targets (min 44px) for accessibility.



6. Conclusion

The proposed changes target the three highest-friction areas: discovery clutter, checkout length, and personalization/accessibility. Together they should reduce time-to-order, increase conversion, and improve inclusivity while preserving Zomato's strengths in tracking and payments.

7. References

- Zomato mobile app (Android/iOS) — observed flows.
- Nielsen Norman Group — usability heuristics.
- WCAG 2.2 — accessibility guidelines.

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